June 29, 2026

Letter of Support — Louisiana Innovation for Thriving Rural Business (LIFT Center), submitted by Southern University and A&M College; MBDA Rural Business Center Program (Assistance Listing 11.805)

RE: Business Center Program — MBDA-OBC-2026-00003 NOFO
Minority Business Development Agency
U.S. Department of Commerce

Dear Members of the Review Committee:

On behalf of the **Global Resource Solutions, Inc. (GRS)**, I am pleased to provide this letter in support of Southern University and A&M College's application to establish the Louisiana Innovation for Thriving Rural Business (LIFT) Center under the Minority Business Development Agency (MBDA) Rural Business Center Program.

GRS is dedicated to the critical mission of supporting U.S. National Security and our Warfighters. As testament to GRS's success, commitment, and capabilities, we are a recognized Mentor in the Department of War (DoW) Mentor-Protege Program (MPP). DoW's Mentor-Protege Program is the oldest continuously operating federal mentor-protege program in existence. Originally established in the midst of the First Gulf War, the MPP helps eligible businesses expand their footprint in the defense industrial base.

GRS has transferred technology to several protege firms supporting a wide array of capabilities and services, including Artificial Intelligence, innovative research, and upgrading IT systems to provide impact that reduces fraud, waste and abuse in the Federal Government. GRS is a multiple award winner of the DoD Nunn-Perry Award for our Defense Intelligence Agency (DIA) and the United States Air Force (USAF) agreements.

The GRS MPP provides an avenue for businesses to achieve entrepreneurial success and contribute to the strength, supplier base and vigor of our economy. GRS's technology transfer initiatives help enhance the capability of our proteges to successfully compete for prime and subcontracting opportunities and contribute to the defense of our nation including the reduction of costs for the federal government.

GRS has made the program an integral part of our sourcing plans while the protege firms have used their involvement in the program to develop much needed technical capabilities to diversify their customer base. We are committed to our proteges, and we are committed to supporting the warfighter through MPP.

We have worked closely with Southern University over the last 12 years to bring new technology and capabilities through the University to our protégé firms and we plan to utilize Southern's new additive Manufacturing Laboratory to enhance our protégé capabilities in the additive manufacturing space through research and design.

A large percentage of these Small/Medium businesses/enterprises are located in rural areas across the United States. If the LIFT Center receives an award under this NOFO, the GRS pledges to leverage our experience and connections with the United States Department of War, by helping Louisiana based rural businesses navigate and take advantage of the extensive contracting opportunities offered by the Military commands, bases, and installations in their localities/regions.

We respectfully encourage favorable consideration of this application, and look forward to the opportunity to work with Southern University and A&M College to expand opportunities for rural businesses, and strengthen local communities.

Sincerely,



Shehan Goonewardene
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